



English AI
Local Coach

ENGLISH AI · THEORY LESSON

Phone Calls, Appointments & Scheduling

Vocabulary, useful phrases, grammar, writing and conversation practice

Level A2-B1 · 45-60 min · Lesson 15

LESSON GOAL

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to make and receive simple phone calls, ask to speak to someone, schedule or reschedule an appointment, confirm dates and times, and leave a clear message.

Learn phone and scheduling vocabulary first, then practise polite requests and arrangements. Finish with the Conversation Lab by making a phone appointment and changing it after a scheduling conflict.

Communication goal

On the phone, you lose visual context. Speak slightly more slowly, confirm names and times, and repeat important details before ending the call.

[START HERE](#)

Lesson map

A simple sequence: learn the key language, practise the structure, and then use it in a realistic conversation.

01

LEARN

Vocabulary + useful chunks

02

BUILD

Grammar + model dialogue

03

SPEAK

Writing + role-play

Warm-up

1. Do you prefer phone calls or text messages? Why?
2. What kinds of appointments do you usually schedule by phone?
3. What is difficult about understanding English on the phone?
4. How do you confirm that you heard a date or time correctly?

Before you continue

Answer the four questions in English using short sentences. Do not worry about mistakes yet. The goal is to activate the topic before studying the new language.



VOCABULARY 01

Essential vocabulary

Study the meaning and then read each example aloud. Try to connect each word to a real situation from your own life.

WORD / PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE
phone call	ligação	I need to make a phone call.
caller	quem liga	The caller left a message.
extension	ramal	What is her extension?
voicemail	correio de voz	I left a voicemail.
message	recado / mensagem	Can I take a message?
appointment	compromisso / consulta	I have an appointment at 3 p.m.
schedule	agenda / agendar	I need to schedule a meeting.
availability	disponibilidade	What is your availability next week?
time slot	horário disponível	There is a time slot at 10:30.
confirmation	confirmação	You will receive a confirmation by email.
reschedule	remarcar	I need to reschedule my appointment.
cancel	cancelar	I have to cancel tomorrow's meeting.
available	disponível	Is Dr. Lee available this afternoon?
busy	ocupado	I am busy at that time.
hold	aguardar na linha	Could you hold for a moment?
call back	ligar de volta	Can you call me back later?



VOCABULARY 02

Phone and scheduling expressions

These are high-frequency chunks that make phone calls more predictable and easier to manage.

EXPRESSION	MEANING	EXAMPLE / USE
May I speak to...?	Posso falar com...?	May I speak to Mr. Brown?
Who is calling?	Quem está falando?	May I ask who is calling?
put you through	transferir a ligação	I will put you through now.
hold the line	aguardar na linha	Please hold the line.
take a message	anotar um recado	Can I take a message?
leave a message	deixar um recado	Could I leave a message?
call back	ligar de volta	I will call you back this afternoon.
available on	disponível em	Are you available on Thursday?
works for me	funciona para mim	Tuesday at 2 works for me.
does not work for me	não funciona para mim	Friday morning does not work for me.
move the appointment	mudar o compromisso	Could we move the appointment to Monday?
confirm the time	confirmar o horário	Let me confirm the time: 3:30 p.m.

Study tip

Learn complete expressions, not only isolated words. In conversation, retrieving a ready-made chunk is much faster than building every sentence from zero.



USEFUL PHRASES

What to say in real situations

These phrases are designed to be spoken. Read them aloud and imagine the exact situation where you would use each one.

SITUATION	PHRASE	USE / MEANING
Start call	Hello, this is Ana calling.	Identify yourself.
	May I speak to Mr. Green, please?	Ask for someone.
	I am calling about my appointment.	State reason.
Schedule	Do you have anything available on Tuesday?	Ask for a slot.
	Would 2 p.m. work for you?	Offer a time.
	Tuesday at 2 works for me.	Accept time.
Change	I need to reschedule my appointment.	Request change.
	Could we move it to Thursday?	Suggest new date.
	Unfortunately, that time does not work for me.	Reject politely.
End	Let me confirm the date and time.	Verify details.
	Could you send me a confirmation?	Request written confirmation.
	Thank you for your help. Goodbye.	Close call.

Make it yours

Choose three phrases from this page and rewrite them with details from your own life. Personal examples are easier to remember and use naturally.

GRAMMAR FOCUS

Present continuous for arranged future events

Use the present continuous for future plans that are already arranged, especially appointments and meetings with a specific time.

PATTERN	EXAMPLE	USE
present continuous	I am meeting the dentist at 3 p.m.	fixed arrangement
present continuous	We are having a call on Thursday.	scheduled event
question	Are you meeting them tomorrow?	ask about arrangement
available	Are you available at 10?	check schedule
works for me	Thursday afternoon works for me.	accept proposed time

Scheduling formula

DATE -> TIME -> CONFIRM. Never finish a scheduling call without repeating the final date and time.

Mini practice

Complete: I am _____ the doctor at 4 p.m. (see)

Write a question asking if someone is available Friday morning.

Accept: Monday at 3 p.m. -> _____.

Politely reject: Tuesday at 9 a.m. -> _____.

MODEL DIALOGUE

Rescheduling an appointment by phone

The caller states the reason, suggests an alternative, and confirms the final date and time before ending the call.

RECEPTIONIST Good morning, Green Clinic. How can I help you?

CALLER Hi. This is Daniel Costa. I am calling about my appointment with Dr. Lee tomorrow.

RECEPTIONIST Certainly. What would you like to change?

CALLER I need to reschedule because I have a work meeting at the same time.

RECEPTIONIST No problem. Are you available on Thursday afternoon?

CALLER Thursday afternoon should work. What times do you have?

RECEPTIONIST We have 2:00 p.m. or 4:30 p.m.

CALLER 4:30 works better for me.

RECEPTIONIST Great. I have moved your appointment to Thursday at 4:30 p.m.

CALLER Perfect. Let me confirm: Thursday at 4:30, with Dr. Lee?

RECEPTIONIST That is correct. You will receive a confirmation by text.

CALLER Thank you very much. Have a good day.

Confirm aloud

Repeating the date and time at the end catches errors before they become missed appointments.

WRITING PRACTICE 01

Build useful sentences

Translate the sentences into English using the vocabulary and structures from this lesson. More than one answer may be correct.

1. Posso falar com a senhora Miller, por favor?
2. Quem está falando?
3. Você pode aguardar um momento?
4. Posso deixar um recado?
5. Estou ligando sobre a minha consulta.
6. Você tem algum horário disponível na terça-feira?
7. Quinta-feira às duas funciona para mim.
8. Esse horário não funciona para mim.
9. Eu preciso remarcar a minha consulta.
10. Podemos mudar para sexta de manhã?
11. Deixe-me confirmar o dia e o horário.
12. Você pode me enviar uma confirmação?

WRITING PRACTICE 02

Write a scheduling message

A scheduling message should make it easy for the other person to choose a time without a long exchange.

Task: Write 90-120 words asking to schedule or reschedule an appointment or meeting. Explain the purpose, give two or three possible time windows, mention one time you cannot do, and ask the other person to confirm the final option.

Try to include some of these:

- I am writing / calling to...
- Are you available...?
- I am available on...
- I can do...
- Unfortunately, I cannot...
- Would ... work for you?
- Could we move it to...?
- Please confirm...

Simple structure

PURPOSE -> AVAILABILITY OPTIONS -> CONFLICT -> REQUEST -> CONFIRMATION. Give options instead of only asking "When are you free?"

Self-check before you finish

- ☐ Did I clearly state why I need the appointment?
- ☐ Did I give useful time options?
- ☐ Did I mention any important conflict?
- ☐ Did I ask for final confirmation?

CONVERSATION PRACTICE

Role-plays for the AI coach

Open the Conversation Lab and complete each situation before asking the AI to correct you. Try to stay in English even when you need time to think.

Role-play 1 · Book an appointment

Call the AI, acting as a receptionist. Ask for an appointment next week and negotiate a time that fits your schedule.

Role-play 2 · Reschedule

You already have a meeting but now have a conflict. Explain the problem, reject one proposed time politely, and agree on a new time.

Role-play 3 · Leave a message

The person you need is unavailable. Leave your name, reason for calling, callback number placeholder, and a good time to return the call.

Questions to practise

- May I speak to...?
- Who is calling?
- Could you hold for a moment?
- Can I leave a message?
- Do you have anything available on...?
- Would ... work for you?
- Could we move it to...?
- Can I confirm the date and time?

REVIEW

Mini test

Complete this without looking back. The goal is to see what you can produce from memory, not only what you recognize on the page.

1. Translate: correio de voz = _____
2. Translate: remarcar = _____
3. Translate: disponibilidade = _____
4. Complete: I am _____ the dentist at 3 p.m.
5. Ask if Friday morning is available.
6. Accept: Thursday at 2 p.m.
7. Politely reject: Monday at 8 a.m.
8. Translate: “Posso deixar um recado?”
9. Translate: “Eu preciso remarcar a consulta.”
10. Ask for another available time.
11. Ask someone to hold.
12. Confirm Thursday at 4:30 p.m.
13. Ask for written confirmation.
14. What three things should you repeat before ending a scheduling call?
15. Write one future arrangement with the present continuous.

ANSWER KEY

Check and learn from your mistakes

Some answers can vary. The versions below are natural examples using the language taught in this lesson.

Grammar mini practice

- seeing
- Are you available Friday morning?
- Monday at 3 p.m. works for me.
- Unfortunately, Tuesday at 9 a.m. does not work for me.

Writing practice 01 - Suggested answers

1. May I speak to Ms. Miller, please?
2. May I ask who is calling?
3. Could you hold for a moment?
4. Could I leave a message?
5. I am calling about my appointment.
6. Do you have anything available on Tuesday?
7. Thursday at two works for me.
8. That time does not work for me.
9. I need to reschedule my appointment.
10. Could we move it to Friday morning?
11. Let me confirm the date and time.
12. Could you send me a confirmation?

Review strategy

Mark the sentences that felt slow or uncertain. Say those sentences aloud three times, then create one new example with the same structure.

FINISH

Mini test answers + progress check

Use the score only as a guide. The real objective is to understand the topic and communicate without stopping every time you need a new sentence.

1. voicemail
2. reschedule
3. availability
4. seeing
5. Are you available Friday morning?
6. Thursday at 2 p.m. works for me.
7. Unfortunately, Monday at 8 a.m. does not work for me.
8. Could I leave a message?
9. I need to reschedule my appointment.
10. Do you have another time available?
11. Could you hold for a moment?
12. Let me confirm: Thursday at 4:30 p.m.
13. Could you send me a confirmation?
14. date, time, person / purpose
15. Answers vary.

READY FOR CONVERSATION?**If you can do these four things, move to the Conversation Lab.**

- ✓ Start and manage a basic phone call.
- ✓ Schedule and reschedule appointments politely.
- ✓ Use present continuous for fixed future arrangements.
- ✓ Confirm important dates and times before ending the call.

Next lesson suggestion: Complaints, Returns & Customer Service